

AURA — The Complete User Guide

Everything you need to find a room, request and approve bookings, manage the catalogue, and import the semester timetable — written for everyday users, step by step.



Real-time availability



Approvals & conflict detection



Timetable import



Reports & audit



Web + Mobile

Ashesi University · West Africa Time (Africa/Accra) · Print or save this guide as a PDF to share.

● INTRODUCTION

1. What AURA is, and who it's for

AURA (Ashesi University Resource Allocation) is Ashesi's space-management platform. It brings the university's rooms, the live class timetable, maintenance windows and ad-hoc booking requests into one place, so everyone is looking at the same source of truth.

AURA answers one question reliably: **"Is this room actually free at this time?"** It does this by combining three things — the imported semester timetable (lectures), approved bookings, and scheduled maintenance — and showing only the gaps that remain. Staff can request a room in those gaps, a booking officer reviews the request with full conflict information in front of them, and administrators keep the catalogue, semesters and users in order.

Who uses AURA

- ✓ **Lecturers & staff** who need a room for a class, seminar, club or event.
- ✓ **Booking officers** who review and decide on requests.
- ✓ **Timetable administrators** who load each semester's schedule.
- ✓ **System administrators** who run the whole platform.

What it replaces

- ✓ Email chains and spreadsheets for "who has the room?"
- ✓ Double bookings and clashes with lectures.
- ✓ Guesswork about capacity and equipment.
- ✓ Manual record-keeping — every change is logged.



AURA runs on the **web** (any modern browser) and as a **mobile app** with the same search, booking, approvals and reports. This guide focuses on the web app; the mobile screens use the same labels.

● GETTING STARTED

2. Getting started

2.1 Where and how to sign in

LIVE WEB ADDRESS

<https://auragh.vercel.app>

For a local demo on your own machine, AURA runs at

`http://localhost:3001` instead. Use the same accounts and steps either way.

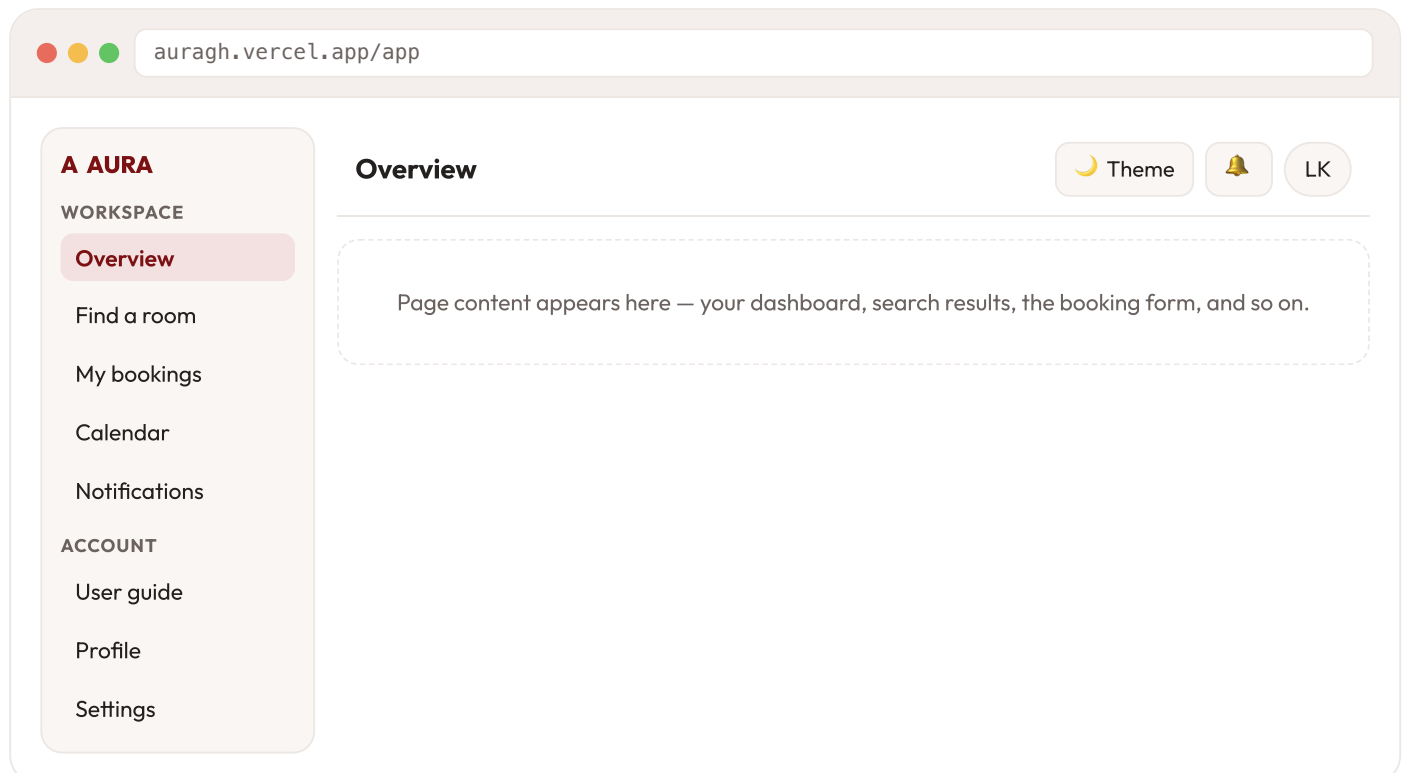
- 1 Open the web address above in a browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari or Firefox), then choose **Sign in**.
- 2 Enter the **email** and **password** for the role you want to use (see Section 3 for the demo accounts).
- 3 Select **Sign in**. You land on the dashboard (the **Overview** page) for your role.
- 4 The very first time, a short guided tour highlights the main areas. You can replay it any time from your account menu → **Replay tour**.



Demo accounts only exist where they've been created. The four sample logins in this guide work on a fresh local demo, and on the live site only if that environment has been seeded with them. If a demo login is rejected on the live site, ask your administrator to create it (or use your own real account).

2.2 A tour of the screen

Every signed-in page shares the same frame, so once you know it for one role you know it for all of them.



Mockup of the AURA web layout. **Tip:** these illustrations approximate the real screens — live screenshots from your environment can be dropped in to replace them.

The five parts of every AURA screen

Area	Where	What it does
Brand & sidebar	Left edge	The A AURA logo plus your navigation, grouped into headed sections. Click the « arrow to collapse it to icons only.
Page title	Top bar, left	Shows the name of the page you're on (e.g. Find a room).
Theme button	Top bar, right	Switches light/dark. Its tooltip reads <i>"Switch to dark theme" / "Switch to light theme"</i> .
Notifications bell	Top bar, right	In-app alerts about your bookings and approvals.
Account menu	Top bar, far right	Your initials. Opens Profile , Settings , User guide , Replay tour , and Sign out .



On a phone or narrow window the sidebar collapses behind the ≡ (menu) button in the top-left — tap it to open the navigation.

2.3 Switching light / dark, and choosing a colour tint

AURA has two separate appearance controls:

- 1 Light or dark mode** — use the **theme button** in the top bar (the sun/moon icon). It flips the whole interface between light and dark and remembers your choice on that device.
- 2 Dark screen tint** — go to **Settings → Preferences** and find the **Appearance** card. Under **"Dark screen tint"** pick one of nine colour casts for dark mode. The card notes: *"Use the theme button in the top navigation to switch modes. These tints change the dark screen colour only."*



The tint only changes how **dark** mode looks — light mode stays the same. The nine tints are **Ink** (the default warm black), **Burgundy**, **Midnight**, **Canopy**, **Slate**, **Ocean**, **Plum**, **Espresso** and **Rose**. Full list in Section 6.

2.4 Signing out

Open the **account menu** (your initials, top-right) and choose **Sign out** — described as *"End your session on this device."* You're returned to the sign-in page. Always sign out on shared or public computers.

● ROLES & ACCESS

3. The four roles & what each can do

AURA shows each person only the tools their role allows. Your role is set by a System Administrator. Every demo account below shares one password: **provided on request**



System Administrator

Full control of the platform

EMAIL

admin@cbs.example.edu

- ✓ Manage users — invite, change role, suspend / reactivate
- ✓ Manage the catalogue: rooms, buildings, equipment (with images)
- ✓ Create & activate semesters; import timetables
- ✓ Approve, reject **or override** any booking
- ✓ Schedule maintenance windows
- ✓ View reports and the read-only audit log



Booking Officer

Reviews & approves requests

EMAIL

officer@cbs.example.edu

- ✓ Open the **Approvals queue**
- ✓ See exactly why a request is **Approvable** or **Blocked**
- ✓ Approve or reject (a reason is required to reject)
- ✓ View utilisation, bookings & conflict reports
- ✓ Search and submit bookings too



Timetable Administrator

Owns the semester schedule

EMAIL

timetable@cbs.example.edu

- ✓ Upload the semester timetable (Excel or CSV)
- ✓ Auto-create missing rooms & buildings on import
- ✓ Choose **Append** or **Replace** mode
- ✓ Review the row-by-row import report
- ✓ Search and submit bookings



Requester (Lecturer / Staff)

Books rooms for activities

EMAIL

lecturer@cbs.example.edu

- ✓ **Find a room** by date, time, capacity, type, building & equipment
- ✓ See live availability before booking
- ✓ Submit a booking request
- ✓ Track and cancel their own bookings



The sidebar adapts to your role: a Requester sees the **Workspace** menu (Find a room, My bookings, Calendar, Notifications), while admin roles also get the **Catalogue**, **Scheduling** and **Administration** menus — but only the items their permissions allow.

● STEP-BY-STEP

4. Step-by-step workflows

Each workflow below is numbered and paired with a screenshot-style mockup of the real screen. Follow them in order the first time, then refer back as needed.

4.1 Requester — find & book a room

Step A — Search for a free room

From the sidebar choose **Find a room**. The page header reads “Search availability derived from the live timetable, approved bookings and maintenance. All times are West Africa Time (Africa/Accra).” Fill in the **Filters** panel:

Find a room — every filter

Filter	Required?	What it does
Date	Yes	The day you want the room.
From	Yes	Start of your time window.
To	Yes	End of your time window. A room must be free for the whole window to appear.
Building	No	Limit to one building. Defaults to Any building ; type to search.
Room type	No	Defaults to Any type . Choices: Lecture hall, Laboratory, Seminar room, Auditorium, Conference room.
Minimum capacity	No	Lowest number of seats you need (placeholder Any).
Required equipment	No	Tick items (e.g. Projector). Only shown when equipment exists.

Select **Search availability**. Before you search you’ll see “Search to see free rooms.” Results show a count line such as “3 rooms free for the entire window”. If nothing matches you’ll see “No rooms free for that window” — try a wider time window, a lower capacity, or fewer equipment requirements.

auragh.vercel.app/app/search

Find a room

DATE

FROM

TO

BUILDING

ROOM TYPE

MIN CAPACITY

2026-07-02

10:00

12:00

Any building

Any type

40

Search availability

Nutor Hall 115

NH-115 · Lecture hall · seats 40

10:00–12:00

08:00–09:30

13:00–14:30

Free (click to book) Occupied Requested window

Mockup: the Filters bar and one result card with its availability bands.

Step B — Read the availability

Each result shows the room name with a sub-line like `NH-115 · Lecture hall · seats 40`. Free slots appear as green **Free (click to book)** bands labelled with the time range (e.g. **10:00–12:00**); busy times show as grey **Occupied**. The legend also marks your **Requested window**. Click a green band to open the booking form pre-filled for that slot.

Step C — Submit the booking request

The booking dialog is titled **Book {room name}** with the same room sub-line. Complete it:

Booking form fields

Field	Required?	Notes
Date	Yes	Pre-filled from the slot you clicked.
Start	Yes	Pre-filled; adjust if needed.
End	Yes	Pre-filled; must be after Start.
Expected attendees	Yes	1 up to the room's capacity. Helper text reads <i>"Maximum {N} for this room."</i>
Purpose	Yes	Why you need the room — e.g. <i>"Departmental seminar, makeup lecture, club meeting."</i> This is how your booking is identified.

Select **Submit request** (it briefly reads *Submitting...*). A confirmation appears: **"Request submitted — You'll be notified once a booking officer reviews it."** Your request starts as **Pending**.

Book a room

Book Nutor Hall 115

NH-115 · Lecture hall · seats 40

Date *

2026-07-02

Start *

10:00

End *

12:00

Expected attendees *

35

Maximum 40 for this room.

Purpose *

e.g. Departmental seminar, makeup lecture, club meeting

Cancel

Submit request

Mockup: the booking form. Fields marked * are required.

Step D — Track and cancel your bookings

Open **My bookings** (“Track the status of every request you’ve made.”). Filter tabs across the top are **All**, **Pending**, **Approved**, **Rejected**, **Cancelled** and **Expired**. Each card shows the room and purpose, then a line like “2 Jul 2026 · 10:00–12:00 · 35 attendees” with a status badge. Click a card to open its detail page with a **Status timeline** and **Details**.



Cancelling is immediate — there is no “are you sure?” step. The **Cancel** button only appears on **Pending** and **Approved** bookings, and only on the **My bookings** list (the detail page has no Cancel button). Clicking it cancels right away and shows “**Booking cancelled**”.

4.2 Booking Officer — review & decide

Step A — Open the approvals queue

From the **Overview** menu choose **Approvals**. The page is the **Approvals queue**: “Each request shows exactly why it can — or cannot — be approved, so you can resolve conflicts without guessing.” Three stat cards at the top show **Pending requests**, **Approved requests** and **Rejected requests**.

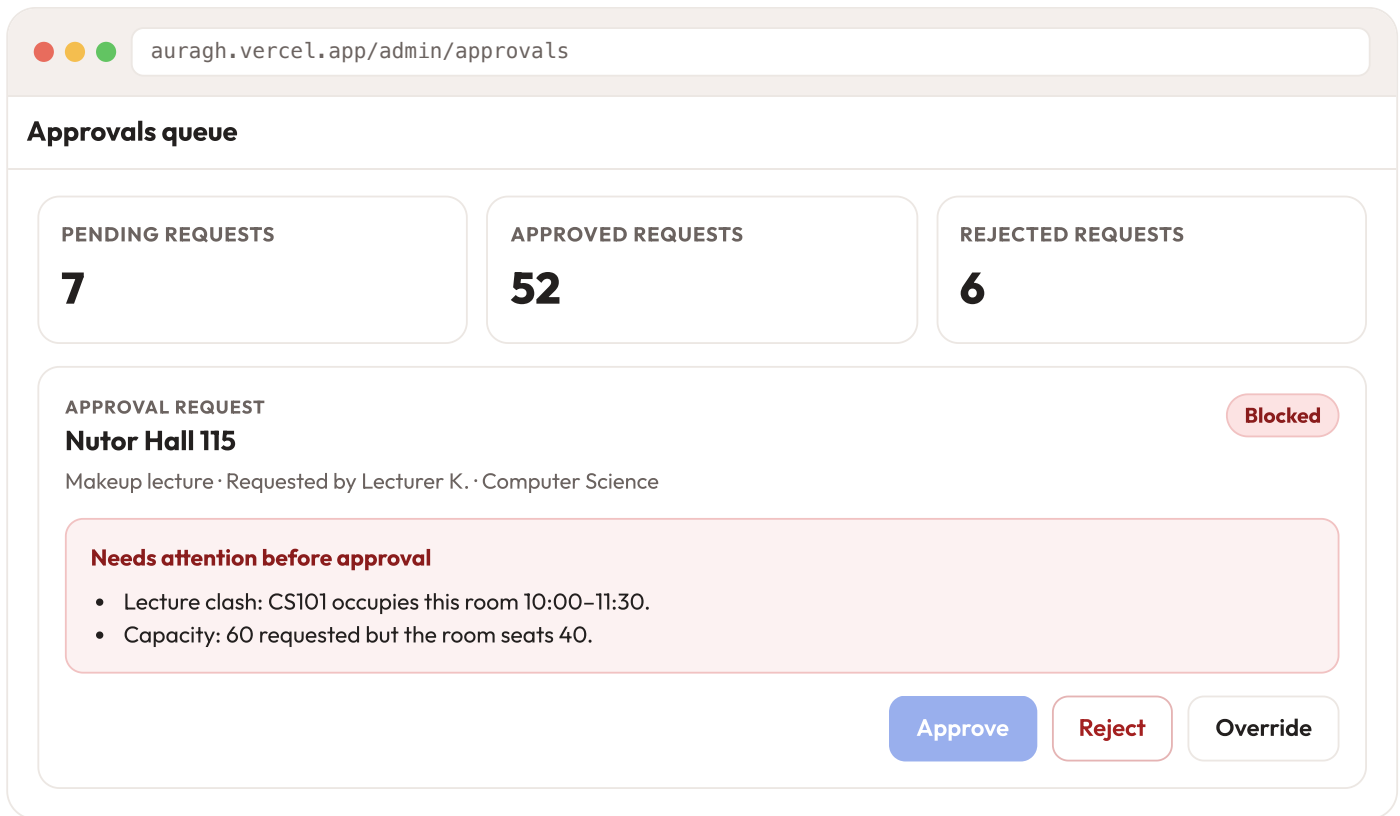
Step B — Read why a request is approvable or blocked

Each request card shows the room, the purpose, the requester (and department), and tiles for **Date**, **Time**, **Attendees** and **Requested by**. A badge reads either **Approvable** or **Blocked**:

- ✓ **Approvable** → a **Ready for approval** panel, e.g. “No lecture, maintenance, capacity, or booking conflicts were detected.”
- ✓ **Blocked** → a **Needs attention before approval** panel listing the reasons. Each blocker is one of these:

Why a request can be blocked

Blocker	Meaning
Lecture clash	A timetabled lecture already uses the room then.
Maintenance	A maintenance window blocks the room.
Approved booking	Another approved booking overlaps.
Competing pending	Other pending requests want the same slot — approving this one supersedes them.
Capacity	Requested attendees exceed the room’s seats.
In the past	The requested time has already passed.



auragh.vercel.app/admin/approvals

Approvals queue

PENDING REQUESTS
7

APPROVED REQUESTS
52

REJECTED REQUESTS
6

APPROVAL REQUEST

Nutor Hall 115

Makeup lecture · Requested by Lecturer K. · Computer Science

Blocked

Needs attention before approval

- Lecture clash: CS101 occupies this room 10:00–11:30.
- Capacity: 60 requested but the room seats 40.

Approve

Reject

Override

Mockup: a blocked request with its reasons and the Approve / Reject / Override actions.

Step C — Approve, reject, or override

- Approve** — available only when the badge says **Approvable**. Click it; you'll see **"Booking approved."**
- Reject** — opens the **Reject this request** dialog. A **Reason** is **required** ("The requester will be notified with your reason") — e.g. "The room is reserved for an examination that week." Click **Reject request**.
- Override** — only for System Admins with override rights, and only on blocked requests. The **Override and approve** dialog warns "This bypasses normal conflict checks" and requires a **Justification**. You can also tick "Cancel any conflicting approved bookings and notify those requesters." The action is recorded in the audit log.

Step D — View utilisation & booking reports

Choose **Reports** ("Utilisation, bookings and conflicts. Export large datasets to CSV, Excel or PDF."). Set the **From / To** date range (defaults to the last 30 days), then use the three tabs:

- ✓ **Utilisation** — a **Room utilisation** bar chart plus a table (**Room**, **Capacity**, **Lecture h**, **Booked h**, **Utilisation**). **Export CSV** downloads it.
- ✓ **Bookings** — metric cards **Total requests**, **Approved**, **Rejected**, **Approval rate**, and a **Bookings by department** chart.
- ✓ **Conflicts** — metric cards **Rejected requests**, **Cancelled bookings**, **Expired requests**.

4.3 Timetable Administrator — import a semester timetable

This is the most important admin workflow. The exact column rules live in Section 5.1; this is the click-by-click procedure.

Before you start

Make sure the semester exists (a System Admin creates it under **Semesters**). Then choose **Timetable** from the **Scheduling** menu. The page is **Timetable import**: "Upload the semester schedule from Excel or CSV. Replacing a timetable never touches existing bookings."

- 1 **Pick the Semester** the file belongs to (a searchable list).
- 2 Choose the **Mode**: **Append** (add to what's there) or **Replace** ("clears existing lecture events for the semester first"). Either way, **existing bookings are never touched**.
- 3 Attach your **File (.xlsx or .csv)**. Not sure of the format? Click **Download CSV template** for a ready-made starter file (`aura-timetable-template.csv`).
- 4 Decide on **Create missing rooms & buildings** (on by default). When on, a Location naming an unknown room is added automatically — see Section 5.1. Turn it off to reject unknown rooms as errors instead.
- 5 Click **Upload timetable**. The **Import progress** panel shows a live percentage and three counters: **Total rows**, **Imported**, and **Needs review**.
- 6 If any rows fail, read the **Row error report** (Row / Field / Message). Fix those rows in your source file and upload again. Imported rows are already live.

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL `auragh.vercel.app/admin/timetable`. The page is titled "Timetable import" and is divided into two main sections: the import form on the left and the import progress panel on the right.

Import form (left):

- Semester ***: A text input field containing "2026/27 Semester 1".
- Mode**: A dropdown menu with "Append" selected.
- File (.xlsx or .csv) ***: A text input field containing "spring-timetable.xlsx".
- Download CSV template**: A button with a downward arrow icon.
- Create missing rooms & buildings**: A toggle switch that is checked. Below it, a description reads: "Adds unknown rooms (and buildings) automatically, seeding capacity from 'Number of Enrollments'".
- Upload timetable**: A large red button with an upward arrow icon.

Import progress (right):

- Import progress**: A header with a green "Completed" badge.
- TOTAL ROWS**: A counter showing "420".
- IMPORTED**: A counter showing "416" in green.
- NEEDS REVIEW**: A counter showing "4" in orange.

Mockup: the import form (left) with the Create-missing toggle, and live progress (right).

4.4 System Administrator — run the platform

The System Administrator can reach everything below. Each item is its own sidebar entry.

Manage users

Open **Users** ("Manage accounts, roles and access across the system.").

- 1 **Add a user** — click **Invite user**. Fill **Full name** and **Email** (both required), pick a **Role** (defaults to **Requester**), optionally set a **Department**, then **Invite user**.
- 2 **Change a role** — on any row open the **Manage** menu → **Change role** → choose System administrator, Timetable administrator, Booking officer or Requester.

- 3 **Suspend / reactivate** — from the same **Manage** menu, **Suspend account** (for active users) or **Reactivate account**. Status badges read **active**, **suspended** or **pending verification**.

Manage rooms, buildings & equipment

Under the **Catalogue** menu:

- ✓ **Rooms** — search by name, code or building; filter by **Room type** and **Status**. **New room** opens a form (**Room code**, **Capacity**, **Name**, **Building**, **Room type**) — save with **Save room**. Row actions: **View**, **Edit**, **Deactivate**.
- ✓ **Buildings** — fields **Code**, **Name**, optional **Campus**. **New building** / **Save**.
- ✓ **Equipment** — fields **Code** (e.g. `PROJECTOR`) and **Name** (e.g. `Projector`). **New equipment** / **Save**.

On any item's detail page, **Add images** opens an uploader with a **Main image** and a **Gallery** — see Section 5.3.

Each catalogue screen also has an **Import** button for bulk CSV/TSV/JSON — see Section 5.2.

Create & activate semesters

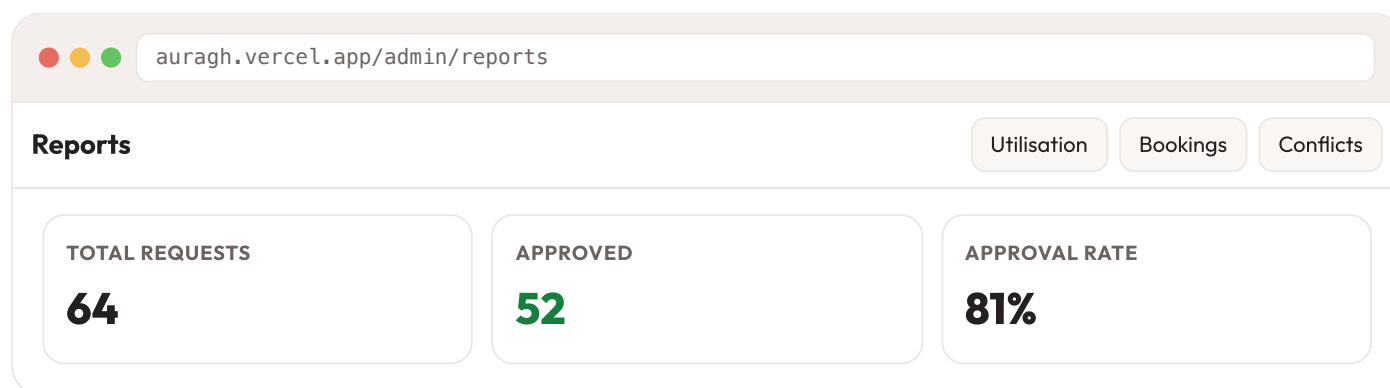
Open **Semesters** (“Only the active semester affects availability.”). Click **New semester**, enter **Name** (e.g. `2026/27 Semester 1`), **Start date** and **End date**, then **Create**. New semesters are **draft**. Use the row buttons **Activate** (makes it the live semester) and **Archive**.

Schedule maintenance windows

Open **Maintenance** (“Blocked periods never appear as available and cannot be booked.”). Click **New window**, choose the **Room** (required), set **Date**, **From**, **To**, and a **Reason** (required, e.g. `Projector replacement`), then **Create**. Remove a window with its **Remove** button.

Override bookings, reports & the audit log

- ✓ **Override bookings** — on the **Approvals** queue, blocked requests show an **Override** button (Section 4.2, Step C).
- ✓ **Reports** — same **Utilisation** / **Bookings** / **Conflicts** tabs and CSV/Excel/PDF export as the officer (Section 4.2, Step D).
- ✓ **Audit log** — “An append-only record of every state change. Read-only.” Columns: **When**, **Actor**, **Action**, **Entity**, **IP**. Filter with “Filter by entity type (e.g. `booking`).”



Mockup: a `stat/reports` row (`Bookings` tab).

● DATA IMPORTS

5. ★ Imports & required columns

AURA accepts uploaded files in three places. This section documents every one of them so your files import cleanly the first time.

The three upload points in AURA

Importer	Where	Accepts	Purpose
Timetable import (main)	Scheduling → Timetable	<code>.xlsx</code> , <code>.csv</code>	Load a semester’s lectures.
Catalogue import	Rooms / Buildings / Equipment → Import	<code>.csv</code> , <code>.tsv</code> , <code>.json</code>	Bulk-add or update catalogue items.
Image uploads	Catalogue detail → Add images	JPEG, PNG, WebP, GIF	Photos for rooms/buildings/equipment.

5.1 Timetable import (the main one)

This is the importer that powers availability — its lecture rows are what AURA treats as “the room is in use”. Document it carefully.

Accepted files & limits

- ✓ An `.xlsx` Excel workbook (only the **first worksheet** is read) or a `.csv` file.
- ✓ Up to **20,000 rows**. Header matching is **case-insensitive**, and surrounding spaces are ignored.
- ✓ Blank rows are skipped. Columns AURA doesn’t recognise are simply ignored.

Required columns (any one accepted name per column)

Timetable — required columns

Column	Accepted header names	Format / rule
Course Code	<code>Course Code</code>	Any text, e.g. <code>CS101</code> . Cannot be blank.
Course Title	<code>Course Title</code> · <code>Course Name</code>	Any text.
Lecturer	<code>Lecturer</code> · <code>Lecturer Name</code> · <code>Staff Name</code>	Any text.
Room	<code>Room</code> · <code>Location</code>	Must identify a room (see “How a room is matched” below).
Day	<code>Day</code>	<code>Mon</code> or <code>Monday</code> (Mon–Sun).
Start Time	<code>Start Time</code> · <code>From Time</code>	24-hour <code>HH:MM</code> (e.g. <code>08:00</code>) or <code>h:mm AM/PM</code> .
End Time	<code>End Time</code> · <code>To Time</code>	Same time formats; must be after Start Time.



If **any** required column is missing entirely, the whole upload is rejected before processing with a message naming the missing column and the names it accepts.

Optional columns (captured when present)

Timetable — optional columns

Column	Accepted names	What it's used for
Section	Section	Stored on the lecture event.
Program	Program	Stored on the lecture event.
Department	Department	Stored on the lecture event.
Number of Enrollments	Number of Enrollments Enrollments	Seeds the capacity of any new room AURA creates for this row.

How a room is matched (and the “Create missing” toggle)

For each row, AURA finds the room by trying, in order: (a) an exact **room code**, then (b) an exact **room name**.
If neither matches:

- ✓ **“Create missing rooms & buildings” ON** (the default) — AURA splits the Location into a building and a room number and creates them. The **last word** is the room number; the rest is the building. So `Nutor Hall 115` → building **Nutor Hall** + room **115**. New rooms are created as Lecture halls, with capacity taken from **Number of Enrollments** (or 30 if absent).
- ✓ **Toggle OFF** — an unknown room becomes a **row error** (“*unknown room*”); that row is skipped, the rest still import.

Append vs Replace

Mode	Effect
Append	Adds the file's rows to the chosen semester's existing lecture events.
Replace	Clears that semester's lecture events first, then imports the file.



Bookings are never touched by either mode — Replace only clears timetabled **lecture events**, not approved bookings or maintenance. This is a core safety rule of AURA.

Other per-row rules

- ✓ End time must be after start time, or the row errors out.
- ✓ Two rows describing the same room + day + exact times are flagged as a “*duplicate of an earlier row in this upload.*”
- ✓ An import finishes as **Completed** (all rows in), **Partially completed** (some row errors), or **Failed** (nothing imported).

Ready-to-copy example file

This is exactly what the in-app **Download CSV template** button produces — paste it into a text file saved as

`.csv`, or recreate it as the first sheet of an `.xlsx`:

Header row + two sample data rows

Course Code	Course Title	Lecturer	Room	Day	Start Time	End Time	Section	Program	Department
CS101	Introduction to Computing	Jane Doe	Nutor Hall 115	Monday	08:00	09:30	Section A	BSc-CS	CSIS
CS101	Introduction to Computing	Jane Doe	Nutor Hall 115	Wednesday	08:00	09:30	Section A	BSc-CS	CSIS

As a single CSV line for the header:

```
Course Code, Course Title, Lecturer, Room, Day, Start Time, End Time, Section, Program, Department
```

5.2 Catalogue import (rooms, buildings & equipment)

Each catalogue screen (**Rooms**, **Buildings**, **Equipment**) has an **Import** button that opens a bulk importer. The dialog says “CSV, TSV or JSON. Expected columns: ...” and lists the columns for that type. It matches existing items by **code** and **updates** them, or **creates** them if new. Column names are case-insensitive and spaces or hyphens are treated as underscores.

Catalogue import — required & accepted columns

Importing	Required columns	Also accepted / optional
Buildings	code, name	<code>campus</code> (optional). Aliases: <code>building_code</code> , <code>building_name</code> .
Equipment	code, name	Aliases: <code>equipment_code</code> , <code>equipment_name</code> .
Rooms	room_code, name, building_code, capacity, room_type, status	Aliases: <code>code</code> , <code>room_name</code> , <code>building</code> / <code>building_name</code> / <code>building_id</code> , <code>seats</code> , <code>type</code> .

Rules for the **Rooms** import specifically:

- ✓ **Building** must match an existing building’s code, name or id (rooms aren’t auto-created here — create the building first).
- ✓ **Capacity** must be a whole number of at least 1.
- ✓ **room_type** is one of `LECTURE_HALL`, `LAB`, `SEMINAR_ROOM`, `AUDITORIUM`, `CONFERENCE_ROOM` (defaults to `LECTURE_HALL` if blank).
- ✓ **status** is one of `ACTIVE`, `INACTIVE`, `UNDER_MAINTENANCE` (defaults to `ACTIVE` if blank).

After running, a summary shows {n} imported, {n} errors and {n} rows read, with a **Rows that need attention** list naming each bad row and why. **Row numbers start at 2** (row 1 is the header).



Quick CSV examples:

Buildings → `code, name, campus`

Equipment → `code, name`

Rooms → `room_code, name, building_code, capacity, room_type, status`

5.3 Image uploads (rooms, buildings & equipment photos)

On a room, building or equipment detail page, click **Add images**. The picker offers a single **Main image** and a multi-image **Gallery** (“*Main image and gallery are uploaded from this device*”). Choose your files, then **Upload images**.

- ✓ Accepted types: **JPEG, PNG, WebP or GIF** only.
- ✓ Up to **12 gallery images** per upload, plus the one main image.
- ✓ Each upload is capped at 40 MB total.



This is a media upload, not a data import — there are no “columns.” It’s listed here so the picture is complete: **aside from images, the timetable and catalogue importers above are the only file imports in AURA.**

● PERSONALISE

6. Settings in depth

Open **Settings** from the sidebar or the account menu (“*Manage your profile, security, notifications and preferences.*”). It has four tabs: **Profile**, **Security**, **Notifications**, **Preferences**.

Profile

The **Edit profile** card lets you keep your details current: **Full name** (required), a read-only **Email** (“*managed by your administrator*”), and an optional **Department**. Save with **Save profile**. The right-hand panel summarises your identity, account status, MFA state, department and last sign-in.

Security — change password

The **Password** card asks for your **Current password**, a **New password** and **Confirm password**, then **Update password**.

Security — enable two-factor authentication (MFA)

The **Multi-factor authentication** card (“*Protect sign-in with a six-digit authenticator code*”) shows your status as **Enabled** or **Not enabled**. To turn it on:

- 1 Click **Enable MFA**. AURA shows a QR code and the heading “**Add AURA to an authenticator app.**”
- 2 **Scan the QR code** with Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, 1Password, or another TOTP app. (If you can’t scan, use **Open authenticator setup**, or copy the **Manual setup secret** with the **Copy** button.)
- 3 Enter the **six-digit code** from the app into the “**Enter six-digit code**” box and click **Verify and enable**.
- 4 You’re done — “*Your next sign-in will ask for an authenticator code.*”

Notifications

The **Notifications** card (“*Choose how AURA alerts you in this browser*”) has an **In-app alerts** toggle (“*Show booking and approval alerts in the top navigation*”). Click **Save notifications** to keep your choice.

Preferences — appearance & theme

The **Preferences** card offers **Spoken guide** and **Compact tables** toggles (**Save preferences**). Below it, the **Appearance** card sets your **Dark screen tint**. Remember: the light/dark switch itself is the theme button in the top bar; these tints only recolour **dark** mode.

The nine dark-screen tints

Tint	Description
Ink (default)	The current warm black AURA screen.
Burgundy	A deeper maroon cast for night work.
Midnight	Cooler charcoal with a quiet blue undertone.
Canopy	A calm green-black tint for low glare.
Slate	A neutral cool-grey screen with very little colour.
Ocean	A deep blue-teal cast for focused evenings.
Plum	A soft violet-black for a warmer night mood.
Espresso	A warm brown-black, easy on the eyes at night.
Rose	A muted dusky-rose tint, softer than burgundy.



All Settings choices in this section are saved **per browser/device**, so you can have a different look on your laptop and phone.

● GOOD TO KNOW

7. Tips & good-to-know



Times are local. Every date and time in AURA is **West Africa Time (Africa/Accra)**. You don't need to convert anything.



There's a mobile app. Search, book, approvals and reports work on mobile too, with the same light/dark themes and labels.



Only the active semester counts. Availability is driven by the one **Active** semester's timetable — so activate the right semester before people start searching.



A room must be free for the whole window. If a room only shows part of your time as free, narrow your **From / To** to that gap.



Replace is safe. Re-importing a timetable in **Replace** mode never deletes anyone's bookings — it only refreshes the lecture rows.



Cancel is instant. There's no confirmation prompt when you cancel a booking — double-check before clicking.

7.1 Glossary

Requester

Anyone who searches for and requests a room (typically a lecturer or staff member).

Booking Officer

Reviews pending requests and approves or rejects them.

Timetable Administrator

Imports each semester's class schedule.

System Administrator

Runs the platform — users, catalogue, semesters, maintenance, overrides, reports, audit.

Semester

A teaching period with a name and dates. Status is **Draft**, **Active** or **Archived**; only the **Active** one drives availability.

Booking states

Pending awaiting a decision · **Approved** confirmed · **Rejected** declined · **Cancelled** withdrawn · **Expired** aged out before a decision.

Room types

Lecture hall, Laboratory, Seminar room, Auditorium, Conference room.

Maintenance window

A blocked period when a room cannot be booked.

Override

An admin forcing a booking through despite conflicts — always logged in the audit trail.

Audit log

An append-only, read-only history of every change in AURA.

7.2 Frequently asked questions

› I searched but no rooms appeared — why?

› How long until my request is approved?

› Can I undo a cancellation?

› My timetable upload says “Partially completed.”

› The importer can't find my room.

› How do I change someone's role or disable an account?

› I forgot my password.

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